

means you have another choice to make. Andrea, you will have to find a job as soon as possible, and, Bill, you'll have to find another job with a more stable income."

"We already decided to do that," Bill offered. "And I realize that I won't be able to go to grad school in the fall."

"Not necessarily," Mr. McKenna said. "If you could live with one set of parents and go to school closer to home, it might be possible to at least start evening classes."

"I don't know about that," Bill said. "I think both of our parents are peeved at us right now."

"Do you really blame them?" Mike asked. "So far, you've gotten married on an impulse, failed to tell the people who love you the most, charged five thousand dollars on someone else's credit card, and a bank in your hometown is ready to sue Andrea's mother."

"I guess when you look at it that way, we don't come out looking too good," Andrea said.

"But it's not too late to change," the elder assured them. "Now it's time to start doing things God's way."

"What do you mean?" Bill asked.

"First, sell whatever you don't actually need to live on, and give the money to your creditors. Look." He read Proverbs 3:27–28 to them: "Do not withhold good from those who deserve it, when it is in your power to act. Do not say to your neighbor, 'Come back later; I'll give it tomorrow'—when you now have it with you."

"Next, contact your creditors and ask their forgiveness. Then work out a repayment plan with them.

"And learn to think and plan before you act. Jesus said, 'Suppose one of you wants to build a tower. Will he not first sit down and estimate the cost to see if he has enough money to complete it? For if he lays the foundation and is not able to finish it, everyone who sees it will ridicule him.' That's from Luke 14, if you'd like to look it up and read it for yourselves later. So from this point on, you both